

DecisionBrief — Conversation Transcript

Scenario: commercial-contractor • Strip Mall 32k sq ft • 22-Year TPO Roof Replacement • 8 Tenants Occupied

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DecisionBrief: Choosing a commercial contractor? Tell me about the property and your role?

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You: I'm commercial property manager for a 32,000 sq ft strip mall in Pearland, 8 tenants — nail salon, dentist, pizza, etc. Built 2002, flat roof is original 22-year-old TPO, leaking in 3 bays. We need full replacement, not patch.

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DecisionBrief: Got it — 32k sq ft, 8 tenants, 22-year-old TPO at end of life, leaks in 3 bays. What triggered the decision to replace now versus repair?

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You: Roof inspection last month showed membrane brittle, seams failing, insulation wet at 40%. Insurance said they won't renew unless replaced within 6 months. Two tenants threatening to withhold rent. Owner wants it done before hurricane season peaks in August.

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DecisionBrief: Understood — insurance non-renewal risk, tenant rent threat, hurricane deadline August. What budget range and who approves the contractor?

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You: Owner approved \$180k-\$240k all-in, but wants 20-year NDL warranty. I manage selection, owner signs. Must include tear-off, new ISO, 60-mil TPO, new drains, parapet flashing, and tenant protection. Permits through City of Pearland.

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DecisionBrief: Clear — \$180k-\$240k, 20-year NDL warranty, tear-off + ISO + 60-mil TPO + drains + parapet, Pearland permits. What schedule and operational constraints?

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You: Cannot close tenants — all work over occupied spaces, weekend and night work preferred. No work during dentist hours Tue-Thu 8am-5pm due to noise. Must be staged — 4 sections so only 2 bays under work at a time. Complete by July 31, before August storms. Need daily cleanup, no debris in parking.

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DecisionBrief: Got it — occupied, phased in 4 sections, no dentist Tue-Thu days, nights/weekends preferred, July 31 hard deadline, daily cleanup. Prior contractor experience?

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You: We used a cheap roofer 7 years ago for patch — left trash, tenants complained, warranty was worthless. Last year we used a GC for parking lot — over budget 30% and 6 weeks late. Owner is burned and wants licensed roofing contractor, not GC subbing to lowest bid.

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DecisionBrief: Understood — burned by cheap roofer and GC overruns, now wants direct licensed roofer with real warranty. What worries you most about this roof project?

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You: Leaks getting worse and causing interior damage we pay for — dentist has \$15k equipment. Tenant business interruption claims if we don't contain. Also contractor discovering rotten deck and change-ordering us to death — we need unit pricing for deck replacement upfront. And 20-year NDL must be manufacturer-backed, not contractor paper.

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DecisionBrief: Thanks — interior damage liability, tenant interruption, deck rot change orders, and paper vs manufacturer NDL warranty are key. If this works, what does success look like in 6 months?

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You: Roof replaced by July 31 with zero tenant closures, 20-year manufacturer NDL in hand, final cost within \$180k-\$240k including deck unit pricing, no tenant damage claims, insurance renewed, and tenants renew leases because we handled it professionally. Owner sees me as protecting asset, not just spending.

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DecisionBrief: I have enough information to prepare your Decision Brief.